

Pliris Public Business Analysis Primer

Purpose

Business analysis enables change by defining needs and recommending solutions that deliver stakeholder value. A useful analysis record connects the business problem to measurable outcomes, requirements, delivery decisions, and validation evidence.

Stakeholder analysis

Identify people and groups who affect or are affected by the change. Record their interests, influence, decision rights, information needs, and preferred engagement methods. Revisit the map as the initiative changes; stakeholder analysis is an ongoing activity rather than a one-time list.

Elicitation

Select elicitation techniques based on the information needed and the participants involved.

Interviews provide depth, workshops build shared understanding, observation reveals actual work, and document analysis establishes existing rules and constraints. Prepare objectives before each session, confirm findings afterward, and separate facts from assumptions.

Requirements and traceability

A requirement should be necessary, clear, feasible, testable, and traceable. Give each requirement a stable identifier. Link it backward to a business need and forward to design, implementation, and acceptance evidence. Traceability helps assess change impact and exposes work that does not support an approved outcome.

Acceptance criteria

Acceptance criteria describe observable conditions that demonstrate a requirement or story is complete. Effective criteria state the triggering context, behavior, and expected result without prescribing unnecessary implementation detail. Include positive, negative, boundary, permission, and failure cases where they affect value or risk.

Process modelling

Model the current state before proposing a future state. Define scope, actors, inputs, activities, decisions, outputs, handoffs, and exceptions. Validate the model with the people who perform the work. Use the comparison between current and future states to identify capability, policy, data, and transition requirements.

Delivery and risk

Prioritize work by value, urgency, risk reduction, learning, and dependency. State risks as an uncertain event or condition, its cause, and its potential effect. Assign an owner and response, then monitor triggers. Delivery planning should preserve traceability from outcome to increment so that teams can measure whether shipped capability produced the expected benefit.

Source and license

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